



BEST PRACTICE SERIES

**Service Vehicle Modifications for
Improved Parts Transportation
(Making the Difference)**

Maintenance and Repair	Application	Component Life Management	Component Renewal (CRC)	MARC Management	
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1.0 Introduction

Safety, as well as the company's image, play a very important role when it comes to the relationship with customers. As a result, the parts delivery and reception is a critical element in the customer experience. Effective and safe transport makes the merchandise arrive to its destination in excellent packaging condition; which supports a costs reduction and shorter delivery times. When it comes to a repeating order to fulfill a need regarding components exchanging of damaged parts, the parts return process time is decreased due to mishandling of parts when they are delivered, keeping the merchandise's integrity.

2.0 Best Practice Description

It is possible to deliver and receive merchandise in excellent condition by making adjustments in the transport used. This can be achieved by adapting the initial structure of the truck and using attachments to improve the loading and unloading process.

The following advantages are obtained by adapting the truck:

- ✓ Side Curtains: Provides weather protection for the parts in the truck's compartments.



- ✓ Latches: Keep the load safe and allows the merchandise to be locked.

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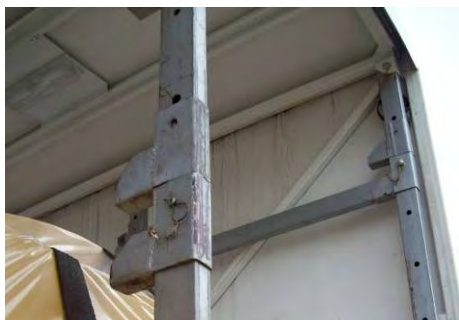
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- ✓ Inside Shelves: The structure itself (inside shelves) allow the merchandise to be stored horizontal or vertically for a better organization and sorted according to the delivery route, making the delivery process faster.



- ✓ Lower Compartments: Small size and low weight boxes can be carried safely inside additional compartments at the bottom of the truck.

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- ✓ Fastening: Fastening elements improve the protection of the load and reduce the time required by the operator to secure.



Fastening
Elements

- ✓ Organization: By taking advantage of the maximum height when the loading process is done, the loading capacity is increased and helps reduce the transport costs significantly.

Placing of the merchandise on shelves makes the unloading operation easier.

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- ✓ Protecting Merchandise: All the parts to be transported (boxes, stowage, components) are placed upon mounted bases and not heaped one on top of the other, helping to keep them safe.



3.0 Implementation Steps

- ✓ Structures were designed and made (inside shelves) that allow each section to be set up differently
- ✓ Lights and folding doors were installed, allowing a larger opening and increasing access, visibility and ventilation when it comes to the handling of the merchandise
- ✓ Latches were installed onto the folding doors in order to protect and keep the load secure
- ✓ Rings were installed on the panels in order to secure single loads safe
- ✓ Fastening elements are available (slings) in order to keep loads secure

4.0 Benefits

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- ✓ **Storage Efficiency:** Increase on the storage density due to the modular shelves inside of the truck. The load distribution is carried out in an organized way.
- ✓ **Faster Delivery:** It gives the transport and delivery process flexibility because it makes the planning, distribution and sorting out of the load easier regarding the delivery route.
- ✓ **Costs Reduction:** The load arrives to its destination safe, therefore; it's not necessary to replace parts that are damaged while transporting.
- ✓ **Loading Time Reduction:** Due to the flexible folding door on two or more vertical hinges that allows one door to be folded one against another, there is more space to place the load.
- ✓ **Increased Load Capacity:** Increasing the load capacity provides a reduction on the number of trips necessary to fulfill the customer's needs, and at the same time it results in increased profitability.

5.0 Resources Required

A truck (only platform):

Investment (approximate cost)

Quoted value for the making of the truck platform metal structure (internal & external) (Materials + workforce) (US\$)	\$ 13,414
Costs of side curtains (US\$)	\$ 3976
Total (US\$)	\$ 17,390

Implementation time	18 working days
Time spent in the design stage	3 weeks

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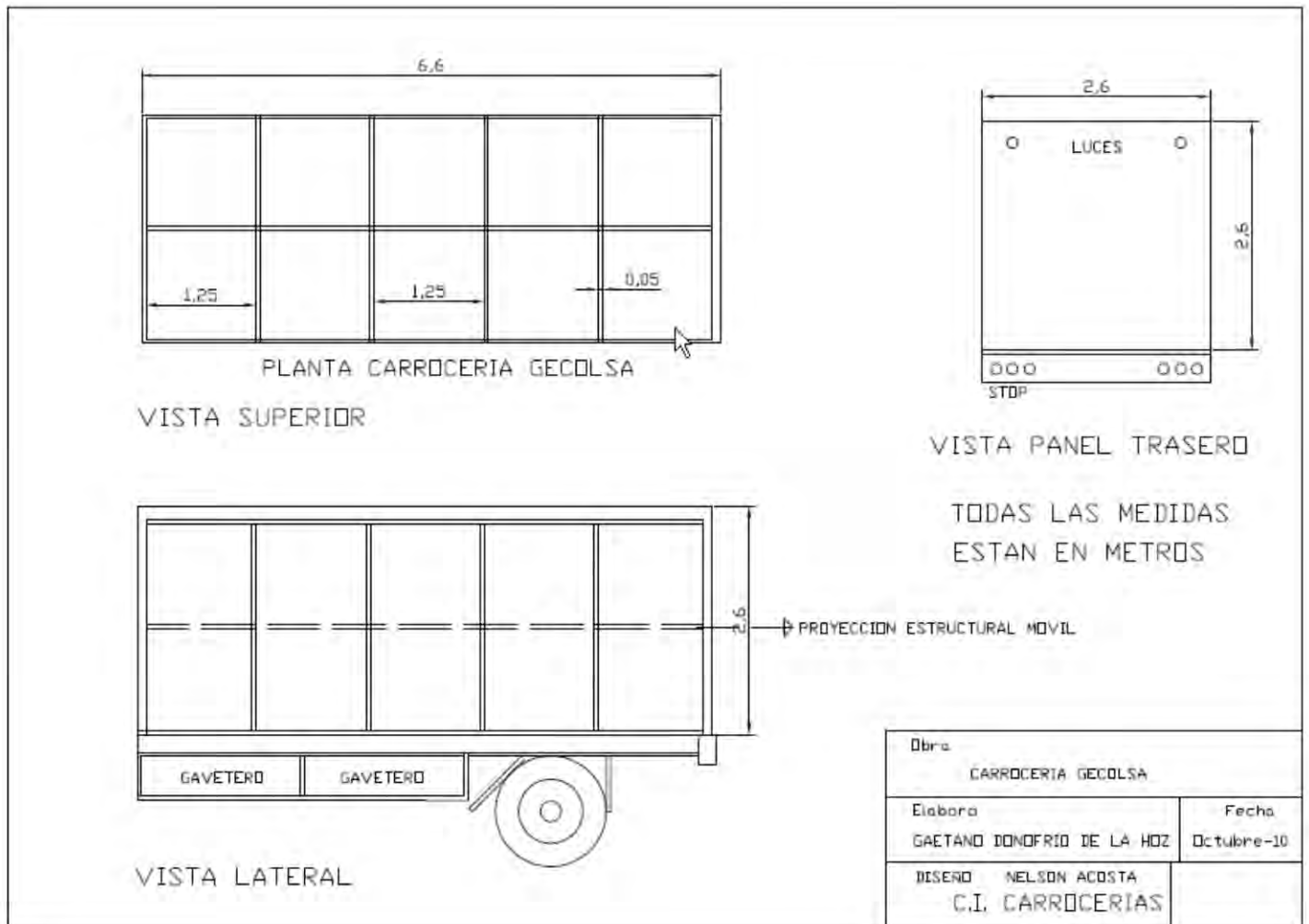
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6.0 Supporting Attachments / References

Service Vehicle Dimensions (meters):



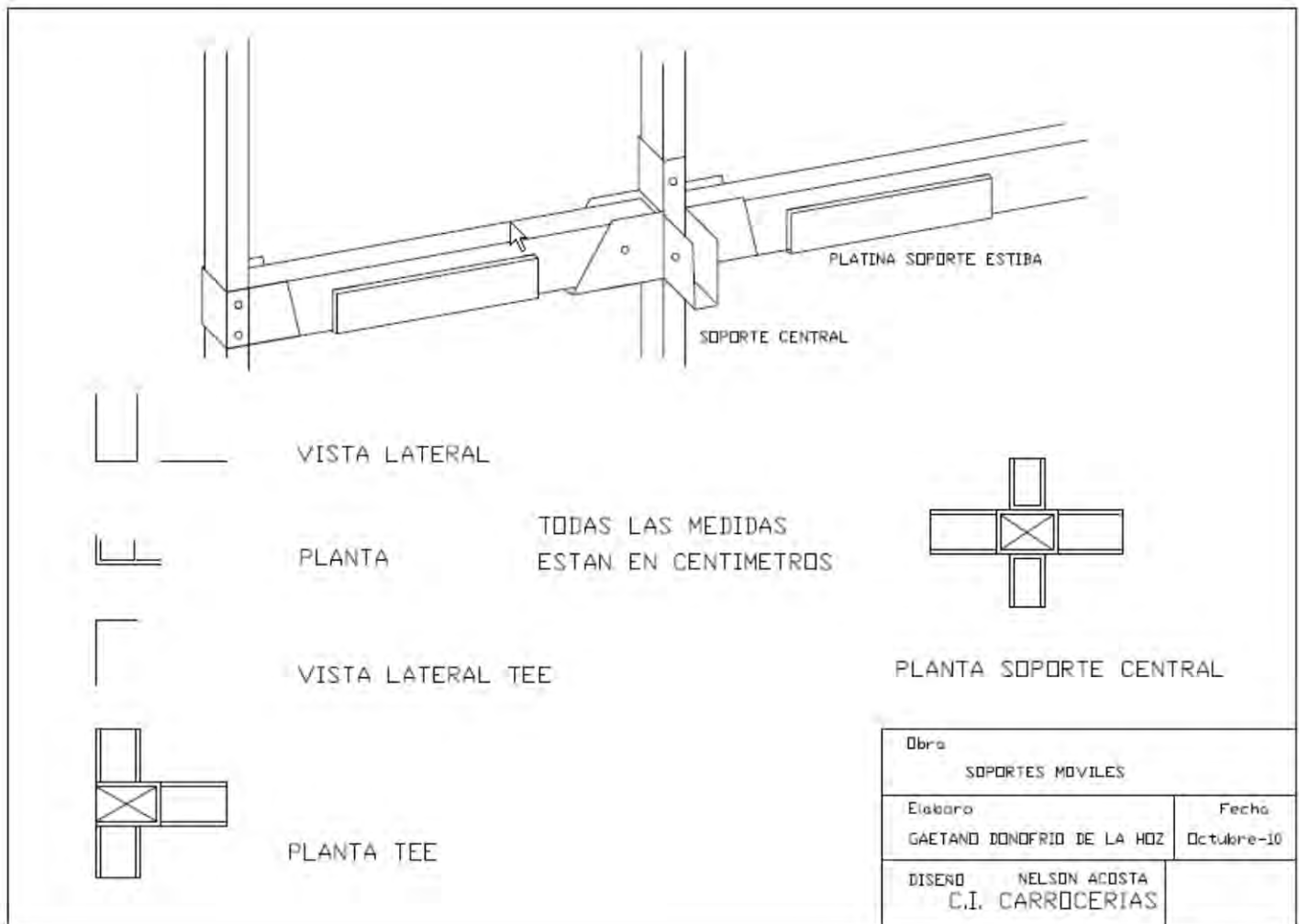
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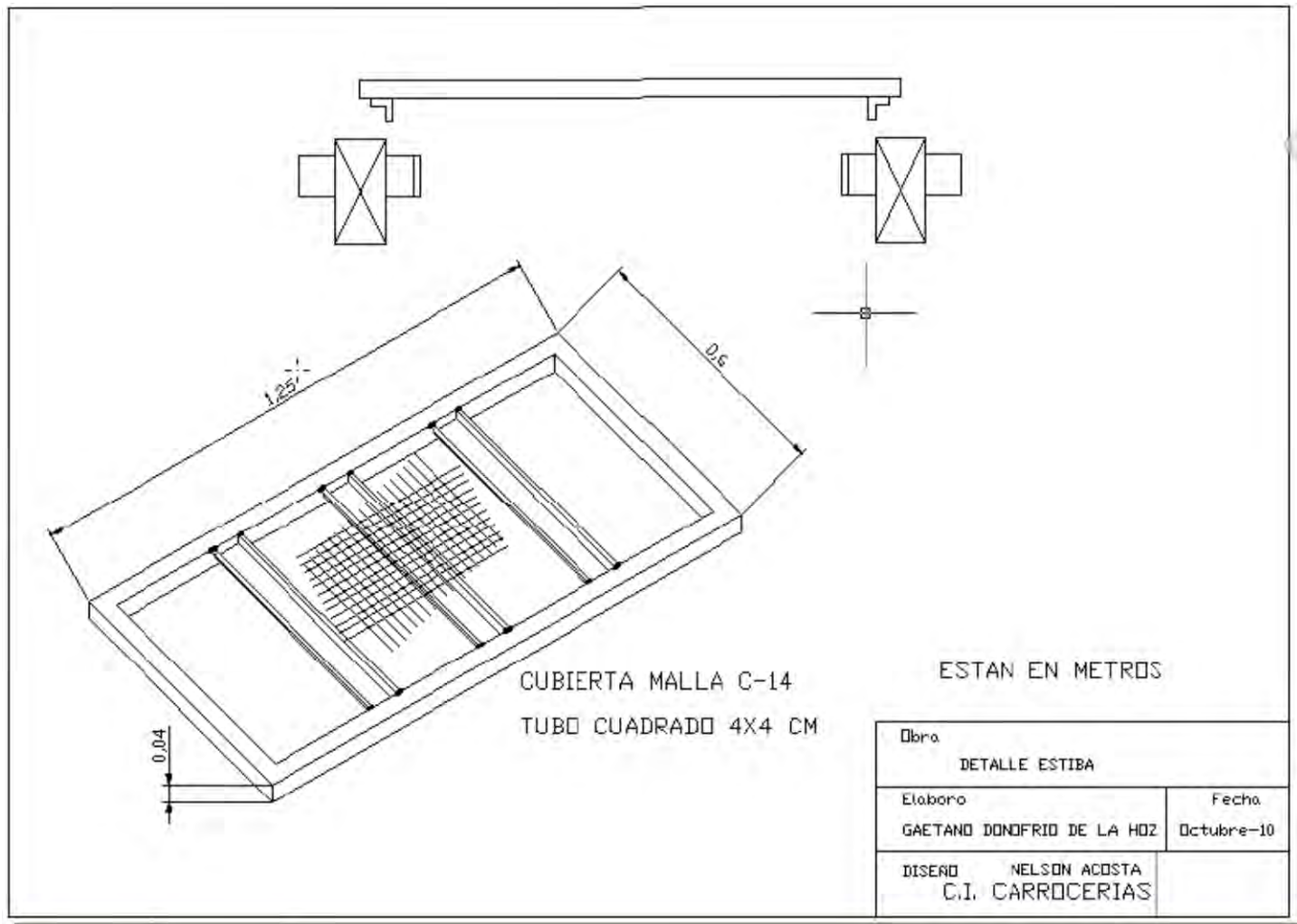
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7.0 Related Best Practices

None

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8.0 Acknowledgements

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Would like to acknowledge the idea for the Parts Shuttle Truck was received from Finning SA.



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